

FREE PROMPT PACK

Living *Paintings*: the prompts

Every prompt I used to put myself inside four surreal paintings that come to life: a porcelain octopus at sea, a swing hanging from Saturn, fishing the moon out of the clouds, and the zodiac circling me. Copy, paste, swap in your own look.

BY WOMEN LEAD AI · WOMENLEAD.AI

BEFORE YOU START

A painting that *breathes*

Each slide is a still painting that quietly wakes up. You stay almost perfectly still in the middle, while the world around you moves: waves roll, a swing rocks, the moon sways on a fishing line, gold animals drift past, and the wind catches your hair and clothes.


The porcelain octopus


The Saturn swing


Fishing the moon


The zodiac orbit

WHAT YOU NEED

- **A Higgsfield account.** Images cost about 3 credits each. A 5 second video clip at 1080p costs 80 credits, or 35 at 720p. My four slides came to about 340 credits, including the character sheets.
- **A character sheet of you.** A plain sheet with your face from the front and close up. If you don't have one yet, make it from 2 or 3 clear photos of your face first.
- **About an hour.** Each video took around 10 minutes to render, and you can run all four at once.

THE THREE STEPS

1. **Dress for each painting:** one character sheet per look, so your face and outfit stay locked.
2. **Paint the scene:** one still per painting, so you see the shot before you pay for video.
3. **Bring it to life:** animate each still in Seedance 2.5 with one clear moving element, plus wind.

Go to Higgsfield here: higgsfield.ai

Step 1

One sheet *per look*

A character sheet locks your face and your outfit, so the video keeps looking like you. Make one for every painting. In Higgsfield go to Images, pick **GPT Image 2.5**, quality high, 2K, aspect ratio **16:9**. Add your own character sheet as the first reference and, once you have it, the painting still as the second, so the outfit matches exactly.

```
Split-screen character sheet composition, left side a full-body shot of the woman standing upright in a neutral straight standing pose facing the camera with both feet flat on the ground and arms relaxed at the sides, full head to toe framing with the whole body and both feet visible, right side a tight close-up chest-up portrait of the same woman with a soft warm confident smile, identical woman on both sides: exactly the face, identity, features and [YOUR HAIR] of the woman in the first reference image. Single subject only, pure white seamless studio background, professional character sheet presentation. She wears exactly the outfit from the second reference image: [YOUR OUTFIT LINE], no jewellery, no bag. Visible fine skin texture with natural pores, natural makeup, no digital smoothing, no beauty filter, no AI airbrushed look. Soft diffused studio lighting, high-end but unretouched commercial photography, 4K, sharp focus. Exactly one person, no props, no furniture, left panel standing full-body head to toe not cropped not sitting, right panel tight close-up, no text, no watermark, no logos, no frame borders.
```



Check it first: make sure the sheet really looks like you before you spend 80 credits on video. Everything after this depends on it.

Step 1

My four looks, *ready to paste*

Drop one of these into the outfit line of the sheet prompt, and of the painting prompt in step 2.

PAINTING	OUTFIT LINE
Octopus	a flowing cobalt blue silk satin bias cut slip dress with thin straps and a V neckline, ankle length, and white pointed toe heels
Saturn swing	a champagne gold liquid satin gown with a square neckline, voluminous puffed balloon sleeves gathered at the wrist with a cuff, a fitted bodice and a long draped asymmetric skirt, gold metallic pointed heels with an ankle strap
Moon	a tailored midnight navy crushed velvet blazer, a cream vintage lace collar spread over the lapels, matching navy velvet high waisted wide leg flared trousers to the floor, black pointed heels
Zodiac	a structured gold floral brocade blazer with sharp sculptural padded shoulders, a fitted waist and a single button, matching gold brocade high waisted extra wide leg trousers to the floor



Saturn swing sheet



Moon sheet

Pick one strong colour per look. Cobalt against blue porcelain, champagne against a navy sky, navy against lilac clouds, gold against teal. The outfit should pop from the painting, not melt into it.

Step 2

Paint the *scene*

Same model, **GPT Image 2.5**, quality high, 2K, but aspect ratio **4:5** for an Instagram carousel. Add your character sheet as the reference. The formula behind every painting:

- **You, photoreal,** inside a hand painted world. The contrast is what makes it look surreal.
- **One giant surreal object** you stand on, sit on or hold: an octopus, a planet, the moon.
- **A frame inside the frame:** a tile border, a brass astrolabe, a painted arch.
- **Room around the moving part.** Keep the thing that will move away from your body, so the video has space to animate it.

```
Surrealist fashion editorial, a photorealistic woman (exact face, identity and [YOUR HAIR] of
the woman in the reference images) placed inside a richly hand-painted [WORLD], like a living
gouache and oil painting. Full-length figure, centred, [POSE], serene confident expression,
looking at camera. She wears [YOUR OUTFIT LINE].

[THE SURREAL OBJECT, where it is, and that it is clearly separated from her body].

Background: [SKY OR SETTING]. A decorative frame within the frame: [BORDER] runs around all
four edges of the image.

Style: surreal, elegant, [ART STYLE], rich painterly textures, soft glow. Strict 4:5
vertical. No text, no logos.
```

Generate 2 at once and pick the one where the moving part has the most open space around it. My octopus had two versions: I chose the one with all eight tentacle tips curling against the sky.

Step 2

The porcelain *octopus*



Surrealist fashion editorial, a photorealistic woman (exact face, identity and long dark hair of the woman in the reference images) placed inside a richly hand-painted, sculptural environment, like a living gouache and oil painting. Full-length figure, centred, standing calmly with arms gently out for balance, serene confident expression, looking at camera. She wears a flowing cobalt blue silk slip dress and white pointed heels.

She stands on top of the head of a GIANT glazed porcelain octopus in blue and white Delft and Portuguese azulejo patterns, glossy ceramic with hand-painted floral motifs. Its eight tentacles spread wide outwards to the left and right of the frame, each tentacle tip clearly visible and separated, curling elegantly against the sky, not touching her. The octopus rests on sculptural stylised blue-grey painted waves with white foam curls (Hokusai inspired, carved relief texture).

Background: pale cream and soft blue sky with painted peach clouds, textured canvas. A decorative frame within the frame: a wide geometric blue and white azulejo tile border runs around all four edges of the image. Patterned tiled floor visible at the bottom.

Style: surreal, elegant, Renaissance meets Mediterranean folk art, soft even light, rich painterly textures, high fashion. Strict 4:5 vertical. No text, no logos.

The Saturn *swing*



Surrealist fashion editorial, a photorealistic woman (exact face, identity and long dark hair of the woman in the reference images) placed inside a richly hand-painted celestial environment, like a living gouache and oil painting. She sits elegantly on a small antique wooden swing seat, hands holding the two ropes, legs crossed at the ankle, serene confident expression, looking at camera. She wears a champagne satin gown with puffed sleeves and gold heels.

The swing hangs from two long golden ropes that rise straight up to the painted ring of a giant planet Saturn at the top of the frame; the planet's banded peach and ochre sphere and its wide ring fill the upper third. The swing hangs in the centre of the frame with plenty of open painted sky around and below her.

Background: deep midnight blue painted night sky with hand-painted gold stars, soft peach and lilac painted clouds in the lower part. A decorative frame within the frame: an ornate antique brass astrolabe and celestial map border with engraved gold zodiac markings runs around all four edges.

Style: surreal, elegant, Renaissance celestial chart meets high fashion, rich painterly textures, soft glow. Strict 4:5 vertical. No text, no logos.

Step 2

Fishing the *moon*



```
Surrealist fashion editorial, a photorealistic woman (exact face,
identity and long dark hair of the woman in the reference images)
placed inside a richly hand-painted dreamlike sky, like a living
gouache and oil painting. Full-length figure standing on a soft
sculptural painted cloud, holding a long slender antique fishing rod
with both hands, the rod angled up and out to the left. Serene
confident expression, looking at camera. She wears a tailored midnight
navy velvet suit with wide-leg trousers, a cream lace collar and black
heels.

From the tip of the rod a thin fishing line hangs straight down, and
on the hook dangles a glowing golden crescent moon (hand-painted,
sculptural, with a softly sleeping face), clearly suspended in open
sky on the left side of the frame, well away from her body.

Background: dusky lilac and twilight blue painted sky with peach
clouds and tiny gold painted stars. A decorative frame within the
frame: an ornate painted border of navy and gold celestial tiles with
small stars and moons runs around all four edges. Clouds at the
bottom.

Style: surreal, elegant, Renaissance meets fairy tale illustration,
rich painterly textures, soft glow. Strict 4:5 vertical. No text, no
logos.
```

The zodiac *orbit*



```
Surrealist fashion editorial, a photorealistic woman (exact face,
identity and long dark hair of the woman in the reference images)
placed inside a richly hand-painted antique observatory, like a living
gouache and oil painting. Full-length figure standing centred on a
round marble pedestal, one hand resting lightly on her hip, serene
confident expression, looking at camera. She wears a structured gold
brocade jacket with sculptural shoulders and matching wide-leg
trousers.

Behind her, a huge painted armillary sphere of thin golden rings
encircles her loosely, and a large circular open space of painted deep
teal night sky with faint constellation lines surrounds her. The space
around her body is EMPTY and open (no animals, no objects floating),
leaving room around her.

Background: painted dome with deep teal and midnight blue, gold stars,
soft peach clouds at the bottom edge. A decorative frame within the
frame: an ornate painted border of teal and gold geometric tiles runs
around all four edges. Patterned marble floor at the bottom.

Style: surreal, elegant, Renaissance celestial chart meets high
fashion, rich painterly textures, soft glow. Strict 4:5 vertical. No
text, no logos.
```

Leave the zodiac out of the still. The empty space around you is on purpose: the video adds the animals and makes them orbit.

Step 3

Bring it *to life*

In Higgsfield go to Video and pick **Seedance 2.5**. These are the exact settings that worked:

Start frame	your painting still from step 2
Reference	the character sheet for that look from step 1
Resolution	1080p (80 credits). Use 720p (35 credits) to test a prompt first
Duration	5 seconds
Aspect ratio	3:4, then crop to 4:5 in your editor
Audio	off. Add one soft breeze sound in your editor instead

Every animation prompt follows the same shape: one clear moving element, wind from the first frame, you held still, and a list of what must not change.

```
The start image is the exact first frame. The reference image is a character sheet of the same woman: keep her face, identity, features, hair and [OUTFIT] exactly as in it throughout. Animate the start image into a subtle, elegant, living surrealist painting. Preserve the exact original composition, framing, camera angle, colours, lighting, painted textures and artistic style.

[HERO ELEMENT]: [what moves and how, slowly, and what keeps it attached or in place].

WIND FROM THE FIRST FRAME: A soft breeze is already blowing from the left from the very first frame, with gentle gusts. Her long hair streams and lifts in the wind, loose strands fluttering naturally, the ends moving the most, never covering her face. [CLOTHING] ripples softly in the same breeze.

SKY: [stars twinkle / clouds drift and billow slowly].

THE WOMAN: [her pose exactly as in the first frame]. Her EYES STAY OPEN the whole time, looking at the camera with a calm, serene expression. No blinking, no closing eyes, no head turn, no change of expression.

ANIMATION STYLE: Restrained, slow, seamless and atmospheric. Several elements alive at once ([list them]), soft and synchronised, like a hand-painted illustration quietly awakening.

CAMERA: Completely locked-off static camera. No zoom, no pan, no tilt, no shake, no reframing.

PRESERVATION: Keep [the border], the woman and all painted details exactly as in the start image. No added objects, no morphing, no melting, no warping, no flicker, no change of art style.
```

Step 3

The moving parts, *word for word*

Paste each block into the template on the previous page, in place of the hero element, clothing, sky, the woman and the list of elements.

THE PORCELAIN OCTOPUS

```
WAVES: The sculptural blue-grey painted waves roll slowly with soft fluid motion, white painted foam curls shifting and swirling along their edges. Preserve the carved relief texture and brushstrokes.
OCTOPUS: The giant blue and white porcelain octopus floats on the waves, bobbing very gently and rocking slightly with the swell. The tips of its tentacles slowly curl and uncurl at slightly different moments. Keep its position, size, shape and glazed porcelain pattern. No sliding, no spinning, no new tentacles.
CLOTHING: Her cobalt silk dress ripples and flutters along its hem.
THE WOMAN: She stands balanced on top of the octopus, riding its gentle bob, arms held out softly for balance as in the first frame.
```

THE SATURN SWING

```
SWING: The wooden swing rocks gently back and forth on its two golden ropes, a slow, small pendulum motion, the ropes staying attached to Saturn's ring at all times.
SKY: The gold painted stars twinkle softly one by one. The peach and lilac painted clouds drift and billow slowly. Saturn and its ring stay still.
THE WOMAN: She sits on the swing holding both ropes, legs crossed at the ankle exactly as in the first frame, riding the swing's motion.
```

FISHING THE MOON

```
MOON: The glowing golden crescent moon sways gently on the fishing line like a slow pendulum, turning very slightly, its soft golden glow pulsing. The line stays connected to the rod tip and to the moon at all times. The rod flexes only very slightly.
THE WOMAN: She stands on the cloud holding the fishing rod with both hands exactly as in the first frame; her hands stay on the rod.
```

THE ZODIAC ORBIT

```
ARMILLARY SPHERE: The thin golden rings of the armillary sphere behind her rotate very slowly around their axis.
ZODIAC: Small hand-painted gilded zodiac animals (a lion, a ram, two fish, a crab, a bull and a scorpion) drift into view and slowly orbit around her at waist height, passing behind and in front of her, glowing softly, in the same painterly gold style.
```

From my redos

Five fixes that *saved me credits*

1. **My eyes closed halfway through.** Seedance loves a slow blink. Write "Her EYES STAY OPEN the whole time", in capitals, plus "no blinking, no closing eyes".
2. **Nothing moved for the first second.** Ask for wind "from the very first frame", then still cut the first 0.8 seconds in your editor.
3. **My first 1080p job failed.** I had added my real face photos as a reference. Use the generated character sheet for that look as the reference instead. Failed jobs are refunded, but you lose 10 minutes.
4. **Auto aspect ratio came out landscape.** Once you add a reference, auto picks 16:9. Choose 3:4 yourself and crop to 4:5.
5. **Only one thing moving looks like a glitch.** Give every painting one hero element plus wind in the hair and clothes, and something small in the sky. That's what makes it feel alive.

MORE WORLDS TO TRY

A Dutch Golden Age still life where you sit on a giant pearl earring. A Japanese ukiyo-e garden where you ride a koi. A Paris pâtisserie dream on a meringue cloud. A botanical encyclopaedia page where pinned butterflies start to flutter. A stained glass night where bats circle a crescent moon.

Want to learn this *with us?*

Women Lead AI is a community of women who build real things with AI: content, videos, websites and whole business systems. Live sessions, prompts that work and people who answer your questions.

Join Women Lead AI

Make yours in Higgsfield: **higgsfield.ai**